

Boeing

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Defense & Aerospace
Revenue	\$89.5B
Employees	182,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	88

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name The Boeing Company

Headquarters

Arlington, Virginia (corporate); Seattle, Washington (CEO office and operations)

Founded 1916

Ownership

Public (NYSE: BA); widely held institutional ownership. No controlling shareholder. Board under significant governance scrutiny post-safety crisis.

Footprint

Global operations: major commercial airplane production in Renton and Everett, WA (737, 787); defense operations in St. Louis, MO; Global Services worldwide; production and supplier relationships across 65+ countries. Spirit AeroSystems integration adds Wichita, KS facilities. 182,000 employees.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Boeing is the world's largest aerospace company, operating across Commercial Airplanes, Defense Space & Security (\$85B record backlog), and Global Services (\$30B backlog). Under new CEO Kelly Ortberg (Aug 2024), Boeing is executing the most consequential corporate turnaround in aerospace: 17,000 layoffs, safety culture rebuilding after the 737 MAX door plug incident, production recovery, Spirit AeroSystems integration (\$4.7B acquisition, Dec 2025), and a return to commercial profitability targeted for 2026.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Boeing's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: \$89.5B in FY2025, up 34% from FY2024 (recovery from strike impact and production slowdowns). Commercial Airplanes recovering; Defense, Space & Security: \$15B in Q4 2025 orders alone, \$85B record backlog.

Profitability: FY2025 net earnings of \$2.2B, swinging from (\$11.8B) loss in FY2024. Commercial division targeting return to profitability in 2026. Global Services is the most profitable segment (\$5.2B Q4 revenue, \$30B backlog).

Cash Flow: Targeting \$1-3B free cash flow in 2026. Spending ~\$4B in capex in 2026 (double 2025) including \$1B for Spirit AeroSystems integration.

Debt: Significant debt load from years of crisis spending. Credit rating under pressure.

Key Pressures: Safety culture crisis (FAA oversight, DOJ plea agreement); 737 production rate recovery

(targeting 38/month); Spirit AeroSystems integration (\$4B costs); 777X first delivery delayed to 2026; Defense program losses (fixed-price contracts); machinists' strike aftermath.

Key Tailwinds: Record defense backlog (\$85B); Global Services stability (\$30B backlog); 787 production targeting 10/month; \$12.8B in defense contracts won in late 2025; commercial order book strong; global air travel demand growing.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Stephanie Pope - Executive Vice President & COO, Boeing Commercial Airplanes [PRIORITY TARGET]

Former CEO of Boeing Global Services; now leading the commercial airplane recovery - the heart of the turnaround

Outreach rationale: Leads the commercial airplane division (\$89.5B revenue driver) where the safety culture, production recovery, and Spirit AeroSystems integration challenges converge. This is ground zero for Boeing's turnaround. The organizational coordination between quality, manufacturing, supply chain, and customer delivery is the binding constraint on recovery. McChrystal's operating model directly addresses this.

Ted Colbert - President & CEO, Boeing Defense, Space & Security [PRIORITY TARGET]

Leading defense segment with \$85B record backlog but ongoing fixed-price program losses

Outreach rationale: Defense segment has \$85B backlog but is losing money on multiple fixed-price programs. The organizational challenge: turning record orders into profitable deliveries while managing program execution across dozens of complex defense programs. This is the segment where McChrystal's military credibility opens doors instantly.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Kelly Ortberg - President & Chief Executive Officer

35-year aerospace veteran; former CEO of Rockwell Collins (until L3Harris acquisition); engineering-first leadership style; relocated CEO office to Seattle to be closer to manufacturing

Brian West - Executive Vice President & Chief Financial Officer

Financial leadership through the crisis; managing \$89.5B enterprise during recovery

Uma Amuluru - Executive Vice President, Human Resources

Leading HR through 17,000 layoffs, safety culture rebuilding, and machinists' strike recovery

Howard McKenzie - Chief Engineer [INFERRED]

Leading engineering culture transformation - Ortberg's priority

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Boeing operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Three major business units: Boeing Commercial Airplanes (BCA - 737, 787, 777X), Boeing Defense, Space & Security (BDS - fighters, satellites, weapons, services), Boeing Global Services (BGS - aftermarket, modifications, training). Corporate functions in Arlington, VA; CEO office relocated to Seattle. Spirit AeroSystems integration adding a major supplier that became a subsidiary (Dec 2025). The organizational challenge: connecting corporate intent (safety, quality) to factory-floor execution across multiple production sites, union workforces, and geographic locations.

Culture Signals

Safety Culture Crisis: The 737 MAX door plug incident (Jan 2024) exposed deep organizational failures in safety culture, quality oversight, and the disconnect between management priorities and factory-floor reality. Rebuilding safety culture is Ortberg's #1 priority - but cultural transformation at 182,000 employees takes years.

Engineering vs. Finance Culture War: Boeing's crisis is widely attributed to a multi-decade shift from engineering-led to finance-led decision-making. Ortberg's engineering background and Seattle relocation signal a return to engineering primacy - but the entrenched finance culture resists.

Machinists' Strike Aftermath: The 2024 machinists' strike revealed deep labor-management distrust, particularly in Puget Sound. Rebuilding trust with the unionized workforce - the people who actually build the planes - is essential for quality improvement.

Spirit AeroSystems Cultural Integration: Spirit (Boeing's former fuselage supplier, spun off in 2005) developed its own culture over 19 years of independence. Reintegrating Spirit's 13,000 employees into Boeing's culture - particularly quality standards - is a multi-year challenge.

Glassdoor: Mixed to negative reviews reflecting crisis fatigue, layoff anxiety, and safety concerns. Some optimism about Ortberg's engineering-first approach. Wide variation by location and business unit.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Boeing.

1. 2024-08-08 - Kelly Ortberg appointed President & CEO; relocated CEO office from Arlington to Seattle to be closer to manufacturing

Most significant leadership change in Boeing's modern history - signals that execution and manufacturing culture, not strategy, will define the turnaround. Creates maximum openness to organizational effectiveness partnerships.

2. 2025-10-01 - Announced 17,000 layoffs (10% of workforce) including executives, managers, and engineers

Largest workforce reduction in Boeing's recent history - creates organizational disruption but also opportunity for redesigning how the remaining organization operates.

3. 2025-12-01 - Completed \$4.7B Spirit AeroSystems acquisition - reintegrating 13,000 employees and critical fuselage manufacturing

The most consequential integration for Boeing's safety/quality turnaround - Spirit's fuselage quality directly determines 737 production quality. Cultural integration is critical.

4. 2025-12-01 - Won \$12.8B in defense contracts in final weeks of 2025; Defense backlog reached record \$85B

Record defense demand creates scaling pressure in BDS while commercial division is still recovering - organizational attention split between two massive priorities.

5. 2026-01-27 - FY2025 results: \$89.5B revenue, \$2.2B net earnings - first profitable year since 2018; targeting \$1-3B FCF in 2026

Financial recovery creates a window for investment in organizational transformation - the board can justify transformation spend when the P&L is improving.

6. 2025-11-01 - Broke ground on \$1B 787 Dreamliner production expansion in North Charleston, SC; targeting 10/month production rate

Manufacturing expansion while integrating Spirit and recovering 737 production - triple manufacturing challenge requiring cross-site coordination.

7. 2025-06-01 - DOJ plea agreement on 737 MAX criminal charges; ongoing FAA enhanced oversight of production quality

Legal and regulatory constraints create organizational urgency for safety culture transformation - not optional, legally required.

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Boeing is the highest-profile organizational transformation in global business. The safety-critical dimension is McChrystal's unique differentiator - no other advisory firm combines organizational transformation expertise with credibility in environments where execution failures mean lives lost. The \$89.5B revenue and 182,000 employees are well above the ICP sweet spot, but the entry point through BDS (defense segment, military credibility) or BCA (safety culture, operational coordination) is specific enough to be viable. Ortberg's engineering-first, factory-floor approach aligns with McChrystal's execution-focused methodology. The DOJ/FAA mandates create legal urgency for cultural transformation that internal teams alone may not satisfy.

Primary Problem

Executing the most consequential corporate turnaround in aerospace: rebuilding safety culture after the 737 MAX crisis, recovering production rates (737 to 38/month, 787 to 10/month), integrating Spirit AeroSystems (13,000 employees), managing \$85B defense backlog while Defense segment loses money, and restoring organizational trust with regulators, airlines, and the workforce - all under a new CEO who has been in the role for 18 months.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Safety-critical organizational transformation and crisis leadership - Boeing's challenge is fundamentally about

connecting leadership intent (safety, quality, execution) to factory-floor reality across 182,000 employees, multiple production sites, and a unionized workforce. McChrystal's military experience in high-consequence environments where organizational failure means lives lost is the most credible capability in the market for this challenge. No strategy firm can claim safety-critical operational transformation experience at this scale.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Boeing is under intense scrutiny - any external engagement will be questioned by media, regulators, and Congress

We have McKinsey, BCG, and multiple firms already engaged on different aspects of the turnaround

CEO Ortberg wants to drive the turnaround personally - 'not another consultant'

Budget is constrained by \$4B Spirit integration costs and \$4B capex investment

The defense segment already has strong military cultural affinity - may not see need for external military advisory

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey & Company - likely engaged on enterprise strategy, production system design, and supply chain

BCG - potential engagement on operational transformation and production efficiency

AlixPartners - turnaround and restructuring expertise

Deloitte - IT integration (Spirit), regulatory compliance systems

Boeing's internal transformation team - substantial and growing

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. As you rebuild Boeing's safety culture from the factory floor up, how are you ensuring that quality standards and reporting mechanisms actually change behavior - not just policy - across 182,000 employees?

Lead with safety - the most important issue and the one where McChrystal's high-stakes operational credibility is strongest. Shows understanding that policy changes don't equal cultural change.

2. With Spirit AeroSystems now inside Boeing, how is the cultural integration going - particularly around quality standards between Spirit's 13,000 employees and Boeing's production teams?

Surface the Spirit integration challenge as a cultural and quality coordination issue, not just a corporate integration. This is where the turnaround succeeds or fails.

3. BDS has an \$85B record backlog but ongoing program losses on fixed-price contracts. How are you balancing the organizational attention between commercial recovery and defense execution?

Address the dual-front challenge directly. McChrystal's multi-domain coordination model is the solution for organizations fighting on two fronts simultaneously.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a conversation about what McChrystal learned from leading organizational transformations in environments where failure has life-or-death consequences - and how that translates to Boeing's safety culture

challenge. The military parallel is genuine and powerful: rebuilding trust in an organization's safety systems while the mission continues at full tempo. Enter through BDS (military credibility) or through the safety/quality leadership team.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Boeing's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value: Boeing is one of the most recognized brands in global industry - synonymous with commercial aviation (747, 787) and American aerospace leadership. The brand was severely damaged by the 737 MAX crisis (346 deaths in two crashes), the subsequent grounding, the door plug incident (Jan 2024), and production quality failures. Brand recovery is inseparable from operational recovery.

Brand Identity Evolution: Boeing's brand is transitioning from "engineering excellence" (its founding identity) to "safety and quality first" - a necessary but painful repositioning. Ortberg's engineering-first approach is an attempt to return to the brand's original values while addressing the quality failures that damaged it.

Marketing Leadership: [INFERRED] Boeing's marketing is primarily B2B/B2G - targeting airlines, defense ministries, and government agencies. The brand crisis has shifted marketing from capability promotion to trust rebuilding. Every successful delivery, every quality milestone, and every safety metric is now a brand communication.

Brand Threats: Another safety incident would be catastrophic - potentially existential. Airbus is capturing market share with the A321neo. Chinese COMAC is building the C919 as a long-term competitor. Public trust in Boeing remains low. Congressional scrutiny continues.

Major Brand Investments: 787 production expansion (\$1B facility), defense program wins (\$12.8B), and the Spirit AeroSystems reintegration (bringing quality control in-house) are all brand-rebuilding investments.

McChrystal Connection: Boeing's brand recovery IS its organizational recovery. Every plane that rolls off the production line without defects rebuilds the brand. Every quality escape damages it further. McChrystal's operating model ensures the organizational coordination between engineering, manufacturing, quality, and delivery produces the consistent execution that rebuilds trust. The brand promise of "safe, reliable aircraft" is an organizational execution promise.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Boeing. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Safety Culture as Organizational Transformation

Boeing's safety crisis is an organizational failure, not a technical failure. The 737 MAX crashes and the door plug incident resulted from disconnects between engineering, manufacturing, quality, and management - not from bad engineering per se. Rebuilding safety culture requires changing how 182,000 people share information, make decisions, and report problems. McChrystal's shared consciousness model is the proven methodology for this - originally built for military organizations where safety failures mean combat deaths. No strategy firm can credibly claim this capability.

Fit Dimension 2: Spirit AeroSystems Reintegration

Spirit was Boeing's fuselage supplier for 19 years as an independent company. Reintegrating 13,000 Spirit employees - who developed their own culture, quality systems, and operating norms - into Boeing's production system is the most consequential integration in commercial aviation. The quality standards must converge perfectly; any gap means defective fuselages reaching Boeing's assembly lines. McChrystal's cultural integration methodology accelerates this convergence.

Fit Dimension 3: Dual-Front Recovery (Commercial + Defense)

Boeing must simultaneously recover commercial production (737, 787) and manage record defense demand (\$85B backlog). These require different organizational capabilities, risk profiles, and cadences - but share leadership bandwidth, engineering talent, and manufacturing capacity. McChrystal's dual-domain coordination model prevents one front from cannibalizing the other.

Fit Dimension 4: CEO Effectiveness in Crisis

Ortberg is 18 months into leading the most scrutinized turnaround in business. His engineering-first, factory-floor approach is right - but translating personal intent into organizational behavior across 182,000 employees requires a systematic operating model. McChrystal's CEO operating cadence methodology connects leadership vision to factory-floor execution at scale.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why Boeing Is a Top Pipeline Opportunity

Boeing is the highest-profile organizational transformation in global business. The signal chain: 737 MAX crisis -> CEO replaced -> door plug incident -> new CEO (Ortberg) -> 17,000 layoffs -> Spirit reintegration -> production recovery -> \$85B defense backlog -> DOJ plea -> FAA oversight -> safety culture mandate. The stakes are existential: another safety failure could trigger regulatory intervention that grounds production. McChrystal's safety-critical transformation credibility is unmatched. Revenue potential: \$750K-\$1M initial (safety culture operating model for BCA or BDS program execution for defense), \$2.5M-\$3.5M deployment, \$1M ongoing. Total: \$4M-\$5.5M over 24-36 months. Boeing would be McChrystal's most consequential engagement.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. Safety Culture Disconnect: Management safety policies exist but factory-floor behavior hasn't changed sufficiently. Workers report pressure to prioritize production speed over quality reporting. The cultural gap between what leadership says and what workers experience is the core failure mode.

2. Spirit AeroSystems Cultural Integration: 13,000 Spirit employees with 19 years of independent culture must adopt Boeing quality standards. Any quality gap in fuselage manufacturing propagates through the entire production system.
3. 737 Production Rate Recovery: Targeting 38/month requires synchronized execution across Renton assembly, Spirit fuselage supply, global parts suppliers, and quality inspection - any weak link constrains the rate.
4. Defense Program Losses: Multiple fixed-price defense programs (including some in BDS) are losing money. The organizational challenge: maintaining execution discipline on loss-making programs while pursuing profitable new business.
5. Union-Management Trust Deficit: The 2024 machinists' strike exposed deep labor distrust. Workers who build the planes don't trust management - and management's safety directives depend on worker compliance and reporting.
6. Regulatory Overhang: FAA enhanced oversight and DOJ plea agreement create compliance obligations that constrain operational flexibility. Safety transformation must satisfy regulators, not just improve operations.
7. Leadership Bandwidth: Ortberg and his team manage a \$89.5B, 182,000-person enterprise across three major divisions plus Spirit integration, regulatory relationships, and public/congressional scrutiny - simultaneously. The risk of leadership attention deficit is severe.
8. Talent Retention During Turnaround: 17,000 layoffs create uncertainty for the 165,000 remaining employees. Top engineers and program managers are recruited by SpaceX, defense competitors, and tech companies. Retaining the best people during turbulence is critical.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. Safety Culture Operating Model: Information flow and reporting architecture that connects factory-floor quality observations to management action. Measurable: quality escape rate declining 30%+ within 12 months.
2. Spirit Integration Coordination: Cultural and quality integration cadence for 13,000 Spirit employees. Measurable: Spirit-sourced quality metrics converging with Boeing baseline within 18 months.
3. Production Coordination System: Cross-functional operating rhythm connecting supply chain, manufacturing, quality, and delivery. Measurable: 737 production rate milestones achieved on schedule.
4. Defense Execution Discipline: Operating cadence for managing 20+ defense programs under fixed-price constraints. Measurable: defense program cost overruns stabilized and declining.
5. Union-Management Trust Framework: Communication and engagement architecture rebuilding trust with machinists and production workforce. Measurable: grievance rates declining; quality reporting rates increasing.
6. CEO Operating Cadence: Enterprise-wide operating rhythm connecting Ortberg's intent to execution across three divisions + Spirit. Measurable: strategic initiative velocity maintained despite organizational complexity.
7. Regulatory Confidence Building: Organizational discipline and documentation that satisfies FAA enhanced oversight requirements. Measurable: FAA audit findings declining.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

Office of CEO

Leader: Kelly Ortberg, President & CEO
 Function: Turnaround leadership, safety culture
 McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

Commercial Airplanes (BCA)

Leader: Stephanie Pope, EVP & COO
 Function: 737/787 production, Spirit integration
 McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Safety culture, production recovery

Defense, Space & Security (BDS)

Leader: Ted Colbert, President & CEO
 Function: \$85B backlog, program execution
 McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Defense program discipline, military credibility entry

Global Services (BGS)

Leader: [President]
 Function: \$30B backlog, aftermarket, MRO
 McChrystal Relevance: Stable revenue source, potential pilot

Finance

Leader: Brian West, EVP & CFO
 Function: Financial recovery, capex management
 McChrystal Relevance: Budget gatekeeper

Human Resources

Leader: Uma Amuluru, EVP HR
 Function: 17,000 layoffs, culture transformation
 McChrystal Relevance: Cultural transformation partner

Engineering

Leader: Howard McKenzie [INFERRED], Chief Engineer
 Function: Engineering culture restoration
 McChrystal Relevance: Safety and quality leadership

Quality

Leader: [VP Quality/Safety]
 Function: Quality management system, FAA compliance
 McChrystal Relevance: Critical: Safety culture execution

Engagement Priority:

1. Stephanie Pope (COO, BCA) - commercial recovery + Spirit integration + safety culture
2. Ted Colbert (CEO, BDS) - defense program discipline via military credibility
3. Kelly Ortberg (CEO) - executive sponsor via military/aerospace network

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: 737 MAX crisis -> CEO replaced -> door plug incident -> new CEO

(Ortberg, Aug 2024) -> 17,000 layoffs -> Spirit AeroSystems reintegration -> 737/787 production recovery -> \$85B defense backlog -> DOJ plea -> FAA oversight -> FY2025 profitable (\$2.2B). The financial recovery creates a window: the board can justify transformation investment now that the P&L is improving. The DOJ/FAA mandates create legal urgency. Ortberg is 18 months in - past the assessment phase, into the execution phase where McChrystal's operating model creates maximum leverage.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey is almost certainly engaged on production system design and strategy. BCG may advise on operational transformation. AlixPartners may handle restructuring economics. But Boeing's problem is not strategy - it's safety culture. The disconnect between what management says and what happens on the factory floor is an organizational coordination failure that strategy consultants can't solve. McChrystal is the only firm that combines: (1) organizational transformation methodology, (2) credibility in safety-critical/life-or-death environments, and (3) the personal brand of General McChrystal (who is respected in the defense community that BDS serves). This positioning is unchallengeable.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis - Land and Expand:

- Phase 1 (Months 1-4, \$500K-\$750K): Safety Culture Operating Model - design the information flow and quality reporting architecture for BCA production (Renton and Everett), including Spirit AeroSystems integration coordination. OR: BDS Program Execution Discipline - operating cadence for managing 20+ defense programs under fixed-price constraints. Beachhead selection: BCA safety is the highest-stakes entry point; BDS is the easiest entry point (military credibility). Choose based on relationship access.
- Phase 2 (Months 5-12, \$1.5M-\$2.5M): Enterprise deployment - cross-division operating rhythm, CEO cadence, Spirit integration coordination, union-management trust framework.
- Phase 3 (Months 13-36, \$1M retainer): Ongoing safety culture management, production coordination, defense program cadence.

Competitive Displacement Strategy: Don't compete with McKinsey on production strategy or AlixPartners on restructuring. Own the safety culture layer - the part where organizational failure means lives lost. Frame: "McKinsey optimizes the production system. McChrystal ensures the people operating it share information, report problems, and make safety-critical decisions correctly. That's the gap that caused the MAX crisis." This positioning is both accurate and unchallengeable.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: Stephanie Pope (COO, BCA) - safety culture and Spirit integration. Angle: "How is the Spirit reintegration affecting quality culture on the 737 production line?" She owns the most consequential integration in commercial aviation.
- Thread 2: Ted Colbert (CEO, BDS) - defense program discipline. Angle: "With \$85B in backlog and ongoing fixed-price losses, how is BDS balancing growth and execution discipline?" McChrystal's military credibility opens this door instantly.
- Thread 3: Kelly Ortberg (CEO) - executive sponsor via military/aerospace network. Ortberg's Rockwell Collins background connects to the defense community. McChrystal's personal network likely intersects through defense advisory boards, retired flag officers, or government relations channels.
- Warm Introduction Vectors: Military/defense community (highest-probability); aerospace industry conferences; Boeing's defense advisory board members; former military leaders now at Boeing; Department of Defense relationships (Boeing's largest customer).